

PRINTABLE GUIDE

The No-Pick Night Routine

A simple evening routine, a plan to stop picking, a pimple patch guide and a 30-day tracker you can print or fill in on your phone.

This is a cosmetic routine guide, not medical advice. For persistent, painful or cystic breakouts, see a dermatologist.

The 5-minute night routine

1. **Remove makeup and sunscreen** with a gentle cleanser or micellar water.
2. **Wash** with lukewarm water and a mild, fragrance-free cleanser for 30–60 seconds. Don't scrub.
3. **Pat dry** with a clean towel. Use a fresh one every few days.
4. **Moisturize** with a light, non-comedogenic moisturizer. Oily skin needs moisture too.
5. **Patch** any spot that has come to a head. Leave it on overnight.

Keep it boring. Using lots of active products at once (acids, retinoids, spot treatments) is the most common way people irritate their skin. Add one new product at a time and give it 2–4 weeks.

Small habits that help

- Change your pillowcase 1–2 times a week.
- Wipe your phone screen every few days.
- Keep hair products off your forehead at night.
- Wash your face after workouts.

The 2-week no-picking plan

Picking is usually automatic. It happens while you scroll, drive or lie in bed. The fix is to make it harder, not to rely on willpower.

Days	Do this
1–3	Notice. Each time you touch your face, put a tally on the tracker. Don't try to stop yet.
4–7	Block. Put a patch on every spot you'd normally pick. Keep patches in your bag, car and nightstand.
8–10	Replace. Give your hands something else to do in your top trigger spots: a stress ball, a fidget, holding your phone in both hands.
11–14	Mirror rule. No close-up mirrors and bright bathroom lights after 9 pm. Do your routine, then leave.

My top 3 picking triggers

Pimple patch guide

Question	Answer
When do they work best?	On spots that have come to a head (a white or yellow top). On flat, deep bumps they mostly act as a "don't touch" cover.
Which size?	The smallest one that fully covers the spot. 8mm for small, 10mm for most, 12mm for large.
How long?	At least 6 hours, or overnight. A white center means the hydrocolloid absorbed fluid.
With other products?	Put the patch on clean, dry skin <i>before</i> moisturizer around it. Patches don't stick over creams.
When not to use one?	On broken, raw or infected skin, or if the skin around it gets irritated.

30-day tracker

Tick each box when you do it. Use "Notes" for things like stress, sleep, new products or your period. It helps you spot patterns.

Day	Routine done	Didn't pick	Patched spots	8 h sleep	Notes
1	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4	☐	☐	☐	☐	
5	☐	☐	☐	☐	
6	☐	☐	☐	☐	
7	☐	☐	☐	☐	
8	☐	☐	☐	☐	
9	☐	☐	☐	☐	
10	☐	☐	☐	☐	
11	☐	☐	☐	☐	
12	☐	☐	☐	☐	
13	☐	☐	☐	☐	
14	☐	☐	☐	☐	
15	☐	☐	☐	☐	
16	☐	☐	☐	☐	
17	☐	☐	☐	☐	
18	☐	☐	☐	☐	
19	☐	☐	☐	☐	
20	☐	☐	☐	☐	
21	☐	☐	☐	☐	
22	☐	☐	☐	☐	
23	☐	☐	☐	☐	
24	☐	☐	☐	☐	
25	☐	☐	☐	☐	
26	☐	☐	☐	☐	
27	☐	☐	☐	☐	
28	☐	☐	☐	☐	
29	☐	☐	☐	☐	
30	☐	☐	☐	☐	